

Danger on the Page: Danger Detectives

Pick a phrase. Name its kind. Say the effect. Explain with because.

METHOD what the writer does

EFFECT what the reader feels or imagines

KIND sound, body or thought

BECAUSE links the writer's words to the effect

EXTRACT Heather Dawe, *Adventures in Mind*, as printed in the class textbook (pp. 24 to 25).

The **karabiner** made a hollow 'plop' sound as it hit the water beneath us. A wave of realisation and vertigo suddenly washed over me. That sea is real. These cliffs are no place for me – what am I doing here? All it takes is one slip and it could be me hitting the water and quickly sinking as all of my climbing ironmongery drags me down. I felt exposed and, while she was a rope's length away from me, I knew Nirvana was uneasy too. I felt like I was losing control.

The trick with climbing in such places is to turn off the part of your brain that alerts you to the danger you should usually associate with that situation. If you climb enough, you become numbed to this alert, so accustomed to the exposure formed by height, space and location that it's normal. Right there, paused halfway up **Dream**, these places were very normal for me. Hanging around on high mountain crags and sea cliffs formed a regular part of my weekend escapes from **urbanity**. That a falling piece of climbing gear, dropped by my climbing partner, broke this state of mind for me was telling. The sound of the karabiner hitting the sea was all it took.

PART A • DO NOW

5 min • alone

- A1** Method or effect? (a) *The writer uses short sentences.* (b) *The reader feels rushed.*
A2 Which hero's journey stage? *The gate slammed behind Ollie. The forest was full of sounds he had never heard.*
A3 First or third person? *She looked down and her legs shook.*

PART B • DANGER DETECTIVES

12 min • pairs • score points

How to play. Work against another pair. Take turns to claim a phrase. Write your answer in your book. Each phrase scores up to 3: **+1** kind **+1** specific effect (not "danger" or "scary") **+1** a "because" that uses a word from the phrase. The other pair can challenge. Highest total wins. Maximum 24.

1 a hollow "plop" **2** a wave of realisation and vertigo **3** That sea is real. **4** what am I doing here?

5 one slip **6** drags me down **7** I felt exposed **8** numbed

Effects bank: height • falling • helplessness • panic • loss of control • fear of drowning • doubt • being alone

PART C • THE DRILL

13 min • alone • easy to hard

- C1 Kind.** Sound, body or thought? (a) *a hollow "plop"* (b) *what am I doing here?* (c) *vertigo suddenly washed over me*
C2 Effect. "drags me down" suggests: (a) the water is cold (b) she is helpless and being pulled under (c) she is a strong swimmer
C3 Explain only. Write ONLY the because: "One slip" suggests how fragile her safety is, because _____.
C4 Two clues. Use both words: The words "quickly" and "sinking" suggest fear of drowning because _____.
C5 Doctor. Diagnose in ONE word, then rewrite: "*That sea is real*" shows danger.
C6 Doctor. Diagnose, then rewrite: "*I felt exposed*" means she felt exposed.
C7 Doctor. Diagnose, then rewrite: "*A wave of realisation*" is a metaphor so it is good.
C8 Warning notice. Write ONE sentence for a school-trip notice about a cliff path. Make the danger feel real with one sound or body detail.

PART D • EXIT TICKET

5 min • alone • 4 marks

Choose a phrase from the extract you have not used. Write two sentences in your book: its kind, its effect, and a because. Marks: 1 a short phrase 2 the kind named 3 a specific effect 4 a because that uses the writer's word.